

Sources Sought & RFI Guide

These notices are your best shot to influence a federal contract before it's even written.

What it is. Sources Sought (SS) and Requests for Information (RFI) are early agency notices. They're how the government tests the market, usually 6 to 18 months before a real solicitation drops. Your response tells them what's possible, who's out there, and what kind of companies can do the work.

When to use it. Respond to every SS or RFI that's even close to your capabilities. These notices are often your first signal for a new contract. They give you a chance to shape the NAICS code, set-aside, and even the technical requirements in your favor.

How to use it.

- First, read the "Sources Sought / RFI Playbook" in this folder. It walks you through the strategy.
- Then, open the "Sources Sought / RFI Response Template (Word)."
- Fill in your company's details, capabilities, and specific recommendations.
- Focus on showing you understand their problem and have a solution, even if it's just a few pages.

Watch out for. Don't just copy-paste your capabilities statement. Agencies want specific answers to their questions, not a general marketing brochure. Tailor your response.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/sources-sought> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/pre-solicitation> (Pre-Solicitation Window)